Equal Sign Balance

TEACHER KEY

1st Grade Math · Interactive Math · Explore & Reflect

Get started

Put cubes on both sides of a balance. When both sides are worth the same, the scale is level and the equation is true. Open the tool and use it to answer each question.

Explore

1. Put 5 + 3 on the left. Put 6 on the right. What must you add to the right side to balance?

2 (5 + 3 = 6 + 2)

2. Is 8 = 5 + 3 true or false?

True. Both sides are 8.

3. Is 6 + 1 = 6 + 2 true or false? Which side goes down?

False. The right side (8) goes down because 8 is more than 7.

4. Find the missing number: 9 + 4 = __ + 3

10

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Explore more

5. Find the missing number: 7 + __ = 10 + 2

5

6. Write two different ways to balance 10 on both sides.

Any two, for example 4 + 6 = 7 + 3

Reflect

7. Reflect: What does the equal sign mean?

Both sides are worth the same amount.

Teacher notes

- Read equations both ways: 7 = 4 + 3 is as true as 4 + 3 = 7.
- For a missing number, ask: How many is the full side worth? How many does the other side already have?
- Display false equations (6 + 1 = 6 + 2) and ask students to fix them in two different ways.

Standards: 1.OA.D.7, 1.OA.D.8. Accept any correct answer where several are possible, and ask students to explain with the tool's picture.